Holiday Tipping Checklist 2026

Emily Post Institute suggestions, with a budget and a given column

BEFORE YOU GIVE

☐	Suggestions only; stay within your personal budget	Set your budget
☐	Some employers bar cash or gifts	Check employer rules
☐	Add a short handwritten note of appreciation	Write a note

BUILDING

☐	$15-$80, or $15 or more each for several, or a gift	Doorman
☐	$20-$80 or a gift	Superintendent
☐	$15-$40 each	Elevator operator
☐	$10-$30 or a small gift	Garage attendant

HOME AND FAMILY

☐	Up to one week's pay and/or a small gift	Housekeeper
☐	Up to one evening's pay and a small gift from your child	Babysitter
☐	A gift, or $25-$70 per staff member	Day care staff
☐	Up to one week's pay or a gift	Dog walker
☐	No Emily Post amount; check school rules	Teacher

DELIVERY AND MAIL

☐	Non-cash gift, $20 or less	Mail carrier
☐	Small gift only, about $20, no cash	Package deliverer
☐	$10-$30 or a small gift	Newspaper delivery

My notes

Source: Emily Post Institute, Holiday Tipping Guide (suggestions, not rules); U.S. Postal Service, Current Employees - Ethics.